CoreWeave (CRWV)

Josh, earnings desk

3Q26 | Earnings Brief | Post-call version | 11 November 2026

Post-call version. No knowledge base detected; built from web-retrieved documents (SEC 8-K release, company IR, four call transcripts). 10-Q not yet filed. History limited to 3Q25, 2Q26 and 3Q26. Signed: Josh (analysis); Trevor (transcript work); Scott (scorecard).

1 Executive snapshot

Consensus thesis	Investors own CoreWeave for take-or-pay backlog, tight supply and rising price per MW, and avoid it for leverage, refinancing and customer credit; going in, the stock (about $48) and bonds (2032s above 16%, CDS above 1,100bp) priced a funding problem, not an operating one.
Thesis status	**Strengthening**
Versus expectations	Quarter: beat (revenue $3,661mn vs about $3.54bn consensus and $3.45-3.6bn guide; adjusted operating income $379mn vs $200-260mn guide; interest $846mn below the $860-940mn guide). Outlook: above (FY26 revenue raised to $13.0-13.3bn vs $12.86bn LSEG consensus; FY adjusted operating income raised to $1.275-1.375bn vs about $1.07bn consensus; year-end active power above 1.85 GW kept).
Biggest changes	• Adjusted operating margin doubled to 10% (5% in 2Q, 1% in 1Q); FY26 adjusted operating income guide raised 26% at the midpoint, implying about 16.5% in 4Q at the midpoint (15-18% across the range). • Funding plan reframed: no new parent unsecured debt at current yields through 2027, under $5bn of parent-level capital needed, next delayed-draw loan talked at about 7-7.5%. • About $9bn of customer prepayments and deposits due in the next three months; prepayments on about 70% of this year's deals. • Backlog about $132.5bn (+27% QoQ); contracted power above 4.6 GW (+over 900 MW); active power above 1.7 GW (+over 200 MW). • Total debt $46.9bn, up $11.8bn QoQ; 4Q interest guided to $1.05-1.15bn; capex of $14.5bn (management basis) ran above the top of the guide.
Investor takeaway	**The market's funding-crisis view should soften: a beat-and-raise quarter plus a plan to fund 2027 almost entirely at asset level (under $5bn of parent capital, about $9bn of prepayments in three months) strengthens the thesis, but debt rose $11.8bn in the quarter and credit relief now depends on the next delayed-draw loan pricing near 7-7.5%.**
Monitor next quarter	• Pricing and rating of the next delayed-draw loan (talked at 7-7.5%, 'high investment grade' expected). • 4Q adjusted operating margin against the implied ~16.5%, and active power above 1.85 GW at year-end. • 10-Q: top-customer concentration, debt maturities, ATM usage and the basis of the $14.5bn capex figure.

2 Pillar scorecard

Pillar	What the market assumed	What the quarter showed	Verdict	Source
P1 Funding stays open	Asset-level money at tolerable cost; Goldman +100-200bp vs 13.5-15% unsecured	Net $8.0bn of debt raised in 3Q; weighted cost of debt 7.9%; next loan talked at 7-7.5%; under $5bn parent capital needed through 2027; no parent unsecured at current yields	Confirmed	Release; call
P2 Margin ramp holds	Low-teens 4Q margin; 3Q $200-260mn	3Q $379mn (10%); FY raised to $1.275-1.375bn, implying about 16.5% in 4Q at midpoints	Confirmed	Release; our calc
P3 Delivery on schedule	Active about 1.7 GW; YE over 1.85 GW	Over 1.7 GW active (+over 200 MW); YE target kept; 'no material risks' to 2027 deliveries	Confirmed	Release; call
P4 Backlog quality	Backlog at or above about $129bn; concentration easing	Backlog about $132.5bn; over 75% of committed capex through 2027 tied to IG or enterprise; 3Q concentration not yet disclosed (2Q top customer 36%)	Unresolved	Release; call; 2Q 10-Q
P5 Interest covered	EBITDA covers rising interest	Adj. EBITDA / interest 2.7x (2.4x in 2Q); but 4Q interest guide $1.05-1.15bn, up about 30%	Confirmed	Release; our calc

3 Key KPIs

Metric	3Q26	2Q26	3Q25	Flag	Trend
Revenue ($mn)	3,661	2,575	1,365	[↑]	+42% QoQ, +168% YoY
Adj. operating income ($mn) / margin	379 / 10%	128 / 5%	217 / 16%	[↑]	Margin doubled QoQ
GAAP operating income ($mn) / margin	207 / 6%	-49 / -2%	52 / 4%	[↑]	Positive again
Adj. EBITDA ($mn) / margin	2,256 / 62%	1,510 / 59%	838 / 61%	[↑]	
D&A ($mn) / % revenue	1,889 / 52%	1,393 / 54%	630 / 46%	[~]	+36% QoQ
Interest expense ($mn) / % revenue	846 / 23%	640 / 25%	310 / 23%	[↓]	+32% QoQ
Adj. EBITDA less interest ($mn)	1,410	870	528	[↑]	Our calc
Net loss ($mn) / EPS	-709 / -$1.27	-626 / -$1.14	-110 / -$0.22	[↓]	Adj. net loss -529
Active power	>1.7 GW	~1.5 GW	~590 MW	[↑]	+over 200 MW
Contracted power	>4.6 GW	~3.7 GW	~2.9 GW	[↑]	+over 900 MW

Flags: [↑] better, [↓] worse, [~] within ±5% or normal, [?] unavailable. For cost, debt and share lines ↓ means worse for shareholders. Totals are our sums of balance-sheet lines (2Q total $35.1bn on this basis; preview used $35.6bn incl. other items). Sources: 3Q26, 2Q26, 3Q25 releases; call.

4 Guidance (key metrics)

Metric	Guidance	vs. prior	vs. consensus	Mgmt explanation	Analyst read
FY26 revenue	$13.0-13.3bn	Raised (was $12.4-13.2bn)	Above ($12.86bn LSEG)	Execution, pricing, earlier delivery	Citi target to $149; Jefferies cut to $90 (single source)
FY26 adj. operating income	$1.275-1.375bn	Raised (was $0.96-1.15bn)	Above (~$1.07bn VA)	Pricing up ~25% in July, ~10% later	Implied 4Q ~16.5% at midpoints (15-18% range)
Exit-2026 run-rate revenue	$20-21bn	Raised	n.a.	Backlog conversion	Partial; prior figure not captured
FY26 capex	$37-39bn	Low end raised (was $35-39bn)	n.a.	Earlier deployment	Basis of $14.5bn 3Q unclear

Underlying economic performance: improving. Margin gains came from price (structural while supply is tight, cyclical beyond 2027) and from scale absorbing D&A; interest still takes about a quarter of revenue.

5 Top risks and analyst focus

(1) Funding and refinancing: debt +$11.8bn QoQ to $46.9bn; 4Q interest $1.05-1.15bn. (2) Customer concentration: 3Q split not yet disclosed; 2Q top customer 36%. (3) GPU residual vs loan tenor: DDTL 5.5 ~5 years on ~3-year contracts; 130k GPUs roll off in 2027.

Analyst focus (Trevor): six analysts pressed on pricing and returns, power and permitting, and customer mix; nobody asked about loan tenor, depreciation or cost of debt directly. Watch-list: Daryanani (Evercore).

6 Questions for owners

(1) Next loan: which customers back it, advance rate, closing date? (2) DDTL 5.5 tenor vs ~3-year contracts: assumed GPU residual? (3) Is the 2027 EBITDA-less-interest doubling before or after ~$9bn of prepayments? (4) Share of 4Q margin from short-dated ~$40mn per MW contracts? (5) Lab share of backlog; ATM shares sold?

7 Read-across for Kona

CoreWeave has put a price on tenant credit: its delayed-draw loans run from about 225bp over SOFR for investment-grade customers to 550bp for AI labs, and prepayments on about 70% of deals are its cheapest capital. For Kona: price contracts to win prepayment, and prefer investment-grade or large-enterprise tenants over labs if it ever finances GPUs; short-dated capacity at about $40mn per MW against $20-25mn long-dated shows the premium for flexibility. Reopened secured lending helps a Kona tenant fund GPUs, but power-only or hosting still keeps Kona out of the spread.